

NAVEEN REDDY ALKA

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PROFILE

Staff Software Engineer with 17+ years building distributed backend systems at scale — payment platforms, platform frameworks, and multi-datacenter infrastructure. At Credit Karma, owns platform framework serving all engineering teams. Previously architected systems handling billions of transactions and 500M+ objects. Strong Java/Python/Kafka/Kubernetes background with hands-on experience in high-reliability, high-throughput production systems. MS CS, ASU 2021.

SKILLS

Languages: Java (SCJP 98%), Scala, Kotlin, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Perl

Frameworks: Spring Boot, Spring WebFlux, Project Reactor, Hibernate, Finagle, Node.js, GraphQL, Jersey

Messaging: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, ActiveMQ

Databases: Cassandra, Redis, CouchBase, Elasticsearch, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Oracle, MongoDB

Cloud & Infra: AWS, GCP, Azure, Kubernetes, Docker, Nginx, HAProxy, Tomcat

Observability: Datadog, New Relic, Splunk, Sentry, Graphite/StatsD

CI/CD: GitLab CI/CD, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Maven, Gradle, Git

Practices: Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, Event Sourcing, TDD, PCI DSS, Agile/Scrum

EXPERIENCE

Credit Karma, Oakland · Staff Software Engineer · Feb 2022 – Present

- Designed and built the Portal Provider framework — core abstraction for dynamic portal configuration powering **90%+ of Credit Karma portals clients**; foundation of federated portals SDK adopted org-wide.
- Led end-to-end delivery of Dashboard × Portals SDK federation — designed Bridge API for phased A/B rollout, achieved **100% production ramp**, enabled RecSys V2, unblocked HELOC/Home Refi verticals; 5+ public kudos by VP and two Directors.
- Architected Portals Local Eligibility (GA Feb 2025) — moved eligibility into client-side SDK delivering **45% faster rendering** and eliminating redundant upstream network calls.
- Led Data Contracts from inception through production (Oct 2025) — cross-language codegen (TypeScript, GraphQL, Scala), Thrift IDL, automated publish pipeline reducing release time **from days to minutes**; named org-wide adoption lead.
- Resolved critical Talon/Polly production incidents: memory leaks, pm2 socket exhaustion, MGS startup latency spikes; built reusable load testing infrastructure across all Polly teams.
- Own and evolve Finagle-based web framework (EOL Twitter stack) serving all Credit Karma product teams — SLAs, scalability, incremental modernization in Scala and TypeScript.

Turo, San Francisco · Senior Software Engineer · Jan 2021 – Feb 2022

- Resolved critical network, infra, and design bottlenecks — optimized API-to-database patterns reducing latency by up to **30%**.
- Led modernization of high-traffic legacy services, improving reliability across the backend.

Pearson Inc, San Francisco · Senior Software Engineer · Jan 2020 – Jan 2021

- Built cross-cutting platform services (logging, security, metrics, monitoring) using Spring WebFlux + Project Reactor — adopted by all engineering teams.
- Delivered Kafka event pipelines, CouchBase data layer, Kubernetes + AWS shared infra enabling Pearson's reactive architecture roadmap.

Nordstrom, Seattle · Senior Engineer · Mar 2019 – Oct 2019

- Ordering/Allocation team — led decommission of legacy monolithic ordering systems into Kubernetes-native microservices on AWS/GCP with GitLab CI/CD.
- Drove performance optimization and security hardening (Java/Spring/Hibernate, MySQL/Postgres, Docker/Linux).

Wenova Inc, St. Louis · Software Engineer · Mar 2018 – Mar 2019

- Designed Customer Data Hub (CDH) — central microservice exposing REST + GraphQL APIs to 10+ internal systems with Kafka event-driven propagation.
- Delivered Java/Spring/Hibernate services on AWS; XML/XSLT/SOAP data transformation pipelines.

MakeMyTrip, Bangalore · Sr. Principal Software Engineer — Payments Architect · Sep 2016 – Jan 2018

- Sole architect of MakeMyTrip's payments platform revamp — multi-datacenter, multi-tenant system integrating **80+ payment gateways** (HSM, wallets, discounting, fraud management).
- Achieved **50% reduction in payment response time**, **60% reduction in maintenance cost**, **2%+ improvement in payment success rate** over billions of dollars of monthly transactions — driving **millions in incremental revenue**.
- Built and led team of 5; owned full delivery including CTO-level architecture reviews, A/B testing, staged rollout, DR, and CI/CD via Jenkins + Cucumber + Selenium.
- Stack: Java · Spring · Hibernate · MySQL · CouchBase · RabbitMQ · Kafka · Cassandra · Tomcat.

VERSE – DailyHunt, Bangalore · Principal Software Engineer · Apr 2016 – Sep 2016

- Built Books search platform — full-text search, fuzzy matching, autocomplete, vernacular support via Elasticsearch + Node.js serving millions of queries.
- Stack: Java · Spring · Elasticsearch · Node.js · Kafka · Redis · Docker.

Myntra – Flipkart, Bangalore · Technical Lead, Secure Checkout · Dec 2013 – Mar 2016

- Led Secure Checkout team — **100% uptime** at **500M+ active carts** and **150,000+ daily payment transactions** on India's largest fashion platform.
- Built Payment Plan Service (PPS) from scratch — unified all payment instruments with dynamic gateway auto-switching algorithm.
- Engineered 50x traffic scaling for End of Season Sale — Cassandra NoSQL primary + algorithmic distributed sharding over MySQL for 500M+ objects.
- Stack: Java · Spring · Hibernate · MySQL · Cassandra · Jersey · Nginx · ZooKeeper · ActiveMQ · Elasticsearch · HAProxy.

Wavecrest Payment Services · Dev Lead · Nov 2009 – Dec 2013

- Founding member — promoted **3 times in 4 years** (SE → SSE → Lead Eng → Dev Lead).
- Led 8-engineer team: cashier and eWallet products processing **200,000+ card issuances per day** with PCI compliance.
- Delivered financial systems for PartyGaming-Bwin, Reliance, GTECH, TrillionPay, O2.
- Stack: Java · Spring · Hibernate · MySQL · ActiveMQ · SOAP · REST · Redis · Docker · Jenkins.

IvyComptech, Hyderabad · Software Engineer · Jan 2009 – Nov 2009

- Built scalable Affiliates and Loyalty System components on a high-traffic gaming platform.
- Stack: Java · Spring · Struts2 · Perl · MySQL · Ajax · Jenkins.

Cognizant, Hyderabad · Program Analyst · Nov 2007 – Jan 2009

- Core engineer on Amex small business apply site — led Apply-Strategy project: data management upgrade, migration, DOJO framework migration.
- Stack: Java · J2EE · Struts · XSLT · XSD · Dojo · EJB · RMI.

EDUCATION

Arizona State University — MS Computer Science, 2021

National Institute of Technology, Warangal — B.Tech Civil Engineering, 2007